TMFD

Task Force on Music-related Financial Disclosures

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Repetition and change

New music, lasting records and relationships between parts

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Let old songs return to the present

New music is not the only music that deserves a present-tense reading. A work that survives ten or twenty years changes position through performance practice, instrument culture, live scenes and the listener’s own life. TMFD No. 01 begins there: following releases from October 5–11 while reopening records that have already proved they can last.

> Time does not seal a song away.
> It changes where we stand.

Revisiting a record lets today’s ears measure detail, proportion and space again.

The catalogue line moves from TOOL, Animals as Leaders and Tigran Hamasyan toward Polyphia, Plini, Covet, Laufey and No Party For Cao Dong. This is an editorial sequence across progressive metal, instrumental rock, jazz, independent pop and Taiwanese rock. The shared thread is a strong identity between parts, and the way repeated material changes role over time.

Reading needs arrangement

The issue therefore treats neither catalogue music as a ranking nor new releases as a news list. Each spread sets up a material correspondence: weight beside brightness, density beside air, precision beside looseness. The reading order acts like an arrangement, allowing works from different years to alter one another on the page.

Inside this issue

Repeated forms, altered spacing. Original TMFD artwork for this issue.

Eight catalogue coordinates

Eight catalogue coordinates, six releases and previews from this week, one Taipei show, and a short study of how instruments enter music narratives. Every music entry has a clickable route: official YouTube first, with Apple Music and Spotify used when no verified official video is available.

From weight to lightness

The catalogue moves from progressive metal and intricate rhythm through instrumental guitar, jazz and math rock, before arriving at independent pop and Taiwanese rock. The range turns technique into a way of comparing textures rather than the property of one genre.

How to read it

The sequence is not a chart. Enter anywhere; across spreads, notice how a shared appetite for precision becomes a different texture on guitar, piano, voice and synthesizer.

> A good magazine makes familiar songs strange again.

Two kinds of precision, two kinds of weight

TOOL

Schism · 2001

TOOL live in 2006. Archive image.

Lukaszr (uploaded by Andrey Molokovich) · CC BY 2.0

Schism keeps its syncopation, accents and bass motif instantly legible without reducing the piece to a technical display. The same material changes position, weight and emotional pressure. A quarter-century later, precision and physical force still occupy the same frame.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

Animals as Leaders

Physical Education · 2014

Animals as Leaders at the 2014 NAMM Show. Archive image.

ArtBrom from Seattle · CC BY-SA 2.0

Physical Education combines metric illusion, percussive guitar tone and immaculate separation into a sharply shaped instrumental. Technique serves form: the opening locks together like machinery, then melody and drums cast the material in a different light. It remains a useful portal into modern progressive music that values memory as much as complexity.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

Rhythm has more than one touch

Tigran Hamasyan

Drip · 2013

Tigran Hamasyan performing in 2017. Archive image.

Arman Ayva · CC BY-SA 2.0

Drip places Armenian melodic language, the piano’s percussive edge and jazz ensemble motion inside one breath. In the official live studio recording, rhythm is never an abstract calculation; it is bodily pressure passed between players. Read beside heavy instrumental music, the shared concern is accent, while the touch is entirely different.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

Polyphia

G.O.A.T. · 2018

Polyphia in Toronto, 2023. Archive performance image.

Makeworldpedia · CC BY-SA 4.0

G.O.A.T. recasts guitar virtuosity through pop production, 808 weight and a lucid beat. The lines appear dense, yet tone, silence and contour are what linger. It marks Polyphia’s decisive turn: technique stops functioning as an insider code and becomes sound design with direct access to popular culture.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

Melody carries technique elsewhere

Plini

Electric Sunrise · 2016

Plini with Simon Grove on a European tour, 2017.

Raulongo · CC BY-SA 4.0

Electric Sunrise draws power from proportion. Clean tone, granular rhythm guitar and long melodic lines retain their own air, so the climax feels like an alignment of parts already set in motion, rather than an accumulation of notes. It makes brightness feel substantial.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

Covet

shibuya (feat. San Holo) · 2018

Yvette Young with Covet in Hamden, 2022. Archive performance image.

Zrubinphoto · CC BY-SA 4.0

shibuya preserves a light, intimate and almost handmade surface beyond math rock's intricate technique. Yvette Young's melody never rushes to prove difficulty; harmonics and empty beats organise the room. San Holo arrives like a thin wash of light, drawing Covet's early sound toward a city at night.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

How familiar songs keep changing

Laufey

From The Start · 2023

Laufey at Radio City Music Hall, 2024. Archive performance image.

IndieCabaretNYC · CC BY 3.0

From The Start shows that a vintage vocabulary need not become nostalgic imitation. Jazz harmony, a bossa nova pulse and a decisively contemporary voice settle into an effortless three minutes. Its polish comes from proportion: each chord, pause and syllable knows how much room to occupy.

Listen past the vintage vocabulary to the pauses and decays that keep the song in the present.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

草東沒有派對

大風吹 · 2016

No Party For Cao Dong, Simon Says official video frame, 2016.

草東沒有派對 / No Party For Cao Dong · Official video frame · editorial use

Simon Says turns generational anxiety into a rough melody that a room can sing together. Guitar, drums and voice retain their edges, which lets the chorus become a sudden common language in public space. It endures because frustration is never processed into a pretty answer.

The chorus regathers parts that first seem unstable, giving roughness a deliberate proportion.

Official listening · YouTube

Release / artist notes

The long life of a motif

Identity before difficulty

Music often lasts not because it is the most difficult, but because it establishes a physical identity quickly. The bass of Schism, the tonal contour of G.O.A.T. and the harmonic gait of From The Start tell the listener where they are before the full work has unfolded. Technique first becomes a system of recognition.

Repetition must survive change

Durable repetition is rarely simple duplication. A bass note moves, the drums shift gravity, a melody enters late, or a leading part recedes. The material remains identifiable while its relationships change. Precision and feeling are therefore compatible: one makes change perceptible; the other makes it memorable.

Players give structure temperature

A score can mark metre and notes, but it cannot replace touch, decay and the exchange between bodies. Tigran Hamasyan and Animals as Leaders both work with highly organised rhythm, yet the former breathes through piano and ensemble elasticity while the latter polishes guitar-and-drum edges to a hard shine. The useful comparison concerns how structure passes through hands and space before becoming sound.

Tigran Hamasyan, 2017. Arman Ayva · CC BY-SA 2.0. Image source

Weight and space this week

Boss Keloid

Pedestal

06 OCT · 2026

A riff kept in the archive for a decade finally finds its place. Pedestal draws weight from more than distortion: sections stretch, turn and press the opening material back into the centre. It is the second entry into Float & Aperture, due October 23 through Church Road Records.

OFFICIAL AUDIO · YOUTUBE

Release notes

> An old riff need not feel nostalgic. It needs a new position.

Caspian

Far Country

07 OCT · 2026

Caspian in A Coruña, 2014. Archive performance image.

Bene Riobó · CC BY-SA 3.0

Far Country deliberately reduces the tool set, asking distorted guitars and structure itself to carry momentum. For a post-rock band long associated with scale and layering, that restraint feels unusually bold. Caspian’s self-titled album follows on October 16.

APPLE MUSIC

SPOTIFY

Release notes

Elastic machines, fast songs

Jeremiah Chiu

Edge Conditions

09 OCT · 2026

Synthesizers, drums, saxophone, viola and field recordings form a system that keeps changing shape. Plastic Mind / Elastic Machines states the method most clearly: repetition is not a static bed, but a device that rewrites the direction of attention. The album preserves a productive friction between electronic composition and improvising ensemble.

OFFICIAL VIDEO · YOUTUBE

Release notes

> Repetition is not background.
> It controls direction.

Imperial Teen

All Over You

09 OCT · 2026

Imperial Teen performing in 2007. Archive image.
Neil Motteram (Palnu) · CC BY 3.0

The seventh album refuses to turn thirty years into a solemn retrospective. Its title track stays bright, mischievous and lightly abrasive, while harmonies and rhythm keep a dance-floor sense of motion. Imperial Teen’s maturity lies in knowing when a short song should turn and when it should simply end.

OFFICIAL VIDEO · YOUTUBE

Release notes

Live versions rearrange time

Cameron Winter

Live at Carnegie Hall

09 OCT · 2026

Cameron Winter with Geese in Boston, 2024.
Lygonstreet · CC BY-SA 4.0

A piano, a voice close to collapse and Carnegie Hall’s enormous volume create the tension of this live recording. Captured in December 2025 and only now issued as an album, familiar and unreleased songs are reordered into one complete night through the pressure and pauses of performance.

YOUTUBE MUSIC · OFFICIAL ALBUM

Release notes

Alcest

Protection · Live at Hellfest 2022

10 OCT · 2026

Alcest, 2019. Licensed publicity photograph.
Seb.reznyck · CC BY-SA 4.0

At Hellfest, Protection exchanges the studio recording’s haze for stage momentum. The guitar wall becomes more immediate while the melody keeps its lift. The official video previews Live at Hellfest 2022, due December 4, and offers a useful measure of the album’s scale.

OFFICIAL LIVE VIDEO · YOUTUBE

Release notes

Taipei, the next room

Silica Gel

Syn.THE.Size: Ballad of You · Taipei

Silica Gel at SBS Radio, 2022. Video frame.
SBS Radio (에라오) · CC BY 3.0

Silica Gel's Taipei date provides the most direct live extension of this issue. The Korean band holds synthesizers, guitars, cinematic colour and ensemble momentum on the same plane. It rewards close attention to arrangement while still promising the scale of a visually minded rock show.

17

OCTOBER 2026 · SATURDAY

Legacy Taipei

Doors 19:00 · Show 20:00

1 Bade Road Section 1, Taipei

NTD 2,000 / 2,200

Advance / door

Standing admission follows ticket-number order. Door sales will not open if advance tickets sell out; check live inventory on the official page before travelling.

Official tickets · KKTIX

Two songs before the room

Start with NO PAIN for the band's momentum and sheen, then hear how Tik Tak Tok turns an unstable pulse into pop memory.

Silica Gel official channel · YouTube

Instruments are not an appendix

How sound takes shape

Instrument writing becomes interesting when a tool changes the grammar of composition and performance. The range of an eight-string guitar, the balance of a headless design, cymbal decay, or resistance between neck and picking hand determines whether a phrase can be voiced with its intended speed, gravity and grain. Gear belongs to music culture, not merely shopping information.

Larada extended-range guitar detail.

Abasi Concepts · Official brand image · editorial citation

Tosin Abasi / Abasi Concepts

Abasi Concepts writes the demands of extended-range playing into body proportion and ergonomics. Its interest lies in the feedback between design and musical language, rather than celebrity association alone.

Brand and design

Abasi Concepts performance image.

Abasi Concepts · Official brand image · editorial citation

Performance grammar written into objects

Tim Henson / Ibanez

Polyphia places clean tone, nylon strings and digital production in one performing system; the signature guitar extends the band's recent language.

Ibanez · Tim Henson

Tim Henson with an Ibanez signature guitar.

Ibanez · Official artist image · editorial citation

Adam Jones / Gibson

Adam Jones's Les Paul lets weight, sustain, pickups and stage image shape TOOL's dark scale together.

Gibson · Adam Jones Collection

Adam Jones Les Paul Standard in Antique Silverburst.

Gibson · Official product image · editorial citation

Matt Garstka / Meinl

Matt Garstka's drumming asks cymbals to balance a defined edge with quick decay. The musical requirement matters more than one model: metal must let dense rhythm retain air.

Meinl Cymbals · Matt Garstka

Matt Garstka Artist's Choice cymbal set.

Meinl Cymbals · Official product image · editorial citation

Decay decides the phrase ending

Diameter, weight and hammering shape attack, decay and frequency spread, deciding how much air survives between dense accents. When guitars and low frequencies already fill the field, a quick, articulate disappearance becomes part of the arrangement.

Three dates ahead

16 OCT

Caspian

The self-titled album is due; its full sequence will redefine Far Country’s position.

Open

23 OCT

Boss Keloid

Float & Aperture is due; Pedestal will move from long-form single to a place inside an album narrative.

Open

04 DEC

Alcest

Live at Hellfest 2022 is due, placing the stage version inside a complete sequence.

Open

The next issue still begins with records

New releases will remain the first verification priority, while catalogue music will no longer sit in the background. Each issue will let enduring records illuminate the week’s arrivals, presenting music history, current scenes and instrument culture as one continuum.

Listening links

Every listening route prefers a publicly viewable official YouTube upload. When no verified official video exists, Apple Music and Spotify appear together; a single service is used only when it is the sole available platform. Evidence links and listening links remain distinct.

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Primary references

Boss Keloid · Float & Aperture

Caspian · official Bandcamp

Jeremiah Chiu · International Anthem

Imperial Teen · official site

Cameron Winter · Partisan Records

Silica Gel · KKTIX

Abasi Concepts · official imagery

Ibanez · Tim Henson

Gibson · Adam Jones Collection

Meinl · Matt Garstka cymbal set

Sources and links checked October 11, 2026. Streaming access and ticket inventory may vary by region and time.